

Panel 1



The Wrong Turn

CAPTION: Deep in the haunted heart of the hills... one wrong turn changes everything.

NARRATION: They came for the thrill of the adventure. But as twilight bleeds out of the sky, Sathish and his crew realize the forest has other plans.

SATHISH: (Wiping sweat from his forehead, voice tight) Okay, guys... I'll admit it. The trail marker wasn't supposed to look like a pair of jagged teeth.

FRIEND 1: (Clutching their jacket, shivering) Teeth that are about to chew us up and spit us out, Sathish! Look at the sun! It's gone!

FRIEND 2: (Staring into the pitch-black void ahead) And unless we want to spend the night sharing a sleeping bag with wild boars... our only option is right through there.

Panel 2



Dwindling Hope

CAPTION: Welcome to the Guna Cave. Where the sun fears to tread.

NARRATION: Swallowed by an ocean of suffocating darkness, the smartphone's dying battery is their only shield against the creeping shadows.

FRIEND 3: (Breathing in short, panicked gasps) My battery's at four percent! Four! Turn that light up, Sathish! It's too dark?something's breathing out there!

SATHISH: (Sweating, frantically tapping the screen) Keep it together, Maya! Just stay close to each other. Don't let go of the person in front of you!

FRIEND 4: (Voice cracking) We're turning in circles. I know we are. We're never getting out of here!

Panel 3



The Dead End

CAPTION: Nowhere left to run.

NARRATION: The labyrinth laughs at their terror, slamming a monumental fist of jagged stone right in their faces. The maze has won.

SATHISH: (Slamming his fist against the cold rock, eyes wide with fury and disbelief) Dammit! It's a dead end! A complete dead end!

FRIEND 1: (Sliding down the rock wall, head in hands) That's it. We're trapped. We're going to starve in this tomb.

FRIEND 2: (Panicking) I told you we shouldn't have listened to him! We're doomed! We're all doomed!

Panel 4



Taking the Lead

CAPTION: Heroes aren't born when things are easy. They're forged in the dark.

NARRATION: Fear is a virus, but resolve? Resolve is contagious. Sathish takes a breath, pushes the panic down, and steps up.

SATHISH: (Standing tall, jaw set with fierce determination, pointing firmly into the dark) Shut up. All of you, just breathe. We don't quit. Not today.

FRIEND 3: (Looking up, tear-stained and hopeful) Sathish...? What are you doing?

SATHISH: (Smirking, holding up his compass) Look past the boulders. There's a draft coming through that narrow fissure. Air means an exit. Now fall in line behind me—we're walking out of this nightmare!

Panel 5



A Glimmer of Light

CAPTION: Out of the jaws of the earth!

NARRATION: Squeezing through the razor-sharp rocks, battered, exhausted, but unbroken?they push toward the salvation they fought so hard to find.

FRIEND 4: (Coughing, squinting against the brightness) Is that... is that actually??

SATHISH: (Gripping the stone, a triumphant grin breaking across his face) Sunlight, baby! I told you I knew the way out!

FRIEND 1: (Laughing through tears, stepping out into the warmth) Never, ever letting you pick the trail again, Sathish. But... nice work.